

## Alpha decay 3

In this section we derive  $C_3$  from the following half-life data. Rows with  $Z = 90$  are uranium and  $Z = 88$  are thorium. Recall that  $Z$  is atomic number minus two.

| $\log \tau_{1/2}$ | $A$ | $Z$ | $E$  |
|-------------------|-----|-----|------|
| 6.30              | 228 | 90  | 6.80 |
| 14.4              | 230 | 90  | 5.99 |
| 21.5              | 232 | 90  | 5.41 |
| 29.7              | 234 | 90  | 4.86 |
| 34.2              | 236 | 90  | 4.57 |
| 39.5              | 238 | 90  | 4.27 |
| 7.52              | 226 | 88  | 6.45 |
| 17.9              | 228 | 88  | 5.52 |
| 28.5              | 230 | 88  | 4.77 |
| 40.6              | 232 | 88  | 4.08 |

From the previous section we have

$$\log \tau_{1/2} = 2 \left( C_1 \frac{Z}{\sqrt{E}} - C_2 \sqrt{Zr_1} \right) + C_3 \log A + \log(\log 2)$$

Hence the regression model

$$\log \tau_{1/2} - 2 \left( C_1 \frac{Z}{\sqrt{E}} - C_2 \sqrt{Zr_1} \right) - \log(\log 2) = C_3 \log A$$

By ordinary least squares we obtain

$$C_3 = -10.1$$

The regression formula yields the following predicted values.

| $\log \tau_{1/2}$ | Predicted<br>$\log \tau_{1/2}$ |
|-------------------|--------------------------------|
| 6.30              | 5.31                           |
| 14.4              | 14.0                           |
| 21.5              | 21.4                           |
| 29.7              | 29.7                           |
| 34.2              | 34.5                           |
| 39.5              | 40.1                           |
| 7.52              | 6.87                           |
| 17.9              | 17.8                           |
| 28.5              | 28.8                           |
| 40.6              | 41.6                           |

Eigenmath script